VEL SOFTWARE SOLUTIONS · VEL-CSE-001
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# Appendix J — Deployment Checklist (Staging and Production)

## Pre-deployment (T-3 to T-1 days)

- [ ] Change record approved; window agreed with client; stakeholders informed.
- [ ] Release candidate tagged; artifact/image digest recorded; SBOM and scans attached.
- [ ] Environment configuration reviewed (no secrets in repo; values in secret store); configuration diff vs staging checked.
- [ ] Database migrations rehearsed on a copy of production; duration measured.
- [ ] **Verified backup** taken and restore tested; backup location and time recorded.
- [ ] Rollback plan written with decision point and time limit; data-rollback approach defined.
- [ ] Monitoring dashboards and alerts ready; on-call contacts confirmed.
- [ ] Runbook reviewed by a second engineer.

## Deployment

- [ ] Freeze: no other changes to the environment.
- [ ] Maintenance notice shown if downtime is expected.
- [ ] Deploy via pipeline (no manual file copy).
- [ ] Run migrations; confirm version number.
- [ ] Smoke tests: login, one transaction per module, reports, integrations, scheduled jobs.
- [ ] Check logs/metrics for errors; compare latency/error rate to baseline.

## Post-deployment

- [ ] Client SPOC confirms smoke test on production.
- [ ] Hyper-care schedule active (24–72 h); issue channel open.
- [ ] Release notes sent; documentation updated.
- [ ] Change record closed with result and timings.
- [ ] Backups scheduled and first scheduled backup verified.
- [ ] Retrospective logged if any deviation.

## Rollback triggers (example)

- Smoke test failure in a Must function; error rate > 2× baseline for 10 minutes; data-integrity discrepancy; security issue discovered.

## Approval

| Role | Name | Signature | Date |
|---|---|---|---|
| Deployer | | | |
| Approver (Technical Lead) | | | |
| Client sponsor (production) | | | |